

The Thinkification Climb

Thinking tools · teens–adult · 30 minutes · one screen, the free game, this page

For your homeschool table — a 30-minute lesson, zero prep. Open the free game on any screen and follow the five steps. Where a step says “the room/the group,” read it as your family; where it says “host,” that’s you.

1 • THE HOOK (3 min)

“You own one toolbox you carry everywhere: your thinking. When did you last add a tool to it — on purpose?”

2 • PLAY TOGETHER (12 min)

Climb ten questions; each time a named mental tool appears (first principles, inversion, second-order thinking, trade-offs), write the tool’s name on a visible list — the session’s trophy shelf.

Play together: the group votes before anyone clicks, and every explanation is read aloud — the explanation is the lesson.

3 • THE TALK (8 min)

1. Pick one tool from the shelf — where could it have saved you a real mistake?
2. Why does “think about it harder” fail where “think about it differently” works?
3. What decision are you facing right now, and which tool fits it?

4 • SOLO CLIMB (5 min)

Five questions; add tools to the shelf.

5 • THE TAKEAWAY (2 min)

“Smart isn’t a gift; it’s a toolbox, and tools are learnable.”

Homework: Apply ONE shelf tool to one real decision this week; report what changed.

THE TEACHING CREED

You are not the expert; the game is. Your job is to vote last, read aloud well, and ask “why?” one more time than feels natural. Celebrate wrong answers loudly — in here, wrong is where the lesson lives.

GENO — the GSU tutor you can talk to, free, 24/7 in 32 languages — can explain any answer a second way.